

Ārya Samantabhadra Aṣṭottaraśataka Nāma Dhāraṇī Mantra Sahita · Toh 637 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 637 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in English as "The Noble Samantabhadra's One Hundred and Eight Names, Together with Dhāraṇī and Mantra," in Sanskrit as the Ārya Samantabhadra Aṣṭottaraśataka Nāma Dhāraṇī Mantra Sahita, and in Tibetan as

To the Protector I will always turn, and always practice the mantra as well. The Noble Ākāśagarbha's One Hundred and Eight Names, together with dhāraṇī and mantra, is complete.

Homage to Samantabhadra, the supreme great bodhisattva (bodhisattva) endowed with great compassion, who has attained the luminous manifestation of the Dharma equal in essential nature to the boundless and inexhaustible expanse of space, who has attained the body pervading all the maṇḍalas of the earth without distinction of difference, equal to the bodies of the three times, who is the supreme and most excellent of great bodhisattvas with his manifold forms, the supreme bestower of what is excellent and sacred, sovereign over all the grounds of the body of great qualities.

Then at that time the supreme great bodhisattva Samantabhadra of manifold forms entered meditative absorption into the samādhi called the Great

Sovereign of the Inexhaustible Grounds of All Bodhisattvas. And the very moment the great bodhisattva Samantabhadra entered that absorption, there arose an inexhaustible multitude of bodies as numerous as the atoms of the great thousandfold world-system, pervading everywhere. The bodies belonging to the realm of space were arrayed throughout the many maṇḍalas of the earth.

Then the Tathāgatas dwelling in all the inexhaustible buddha-fields extended their right hands and, stroking the crown of the great bodhisattva Samantabhadra's head, declared: "Excellent! Excellent, son of good family! Proclaim the great dhāraṇī that is the very heart of all the arising of buddhas."

Then that supreme great bodhisattva, his body illuminated by hundreds of thousands of rays of light, caused all the buddha-fields to tremble and proclaimed this dhāraṇī:

Tadyathā: Oṃ namo namastrī bhuvanīśvare mahābhogāya asamasama amitasama anantasama gaganasama tribhuvanasama aśeṣasama veṣasama paramārthasama svabhāvasama tathatāsama arajaḥsama śuddhi-sama buddhi-sama dharmatathātāsama abhiṣamasama samasama ekānāya sāgara viśuddhe āloka hī hī labdha labdha vijaya vijaya oṃ prasagata naya naya hi nira adhiṣṭhāna saṃbhoga aṃ analaya laya dharmaagra dhara dhara jaya jaya hūṃ hūṃ dhama dhama svāhā.

Then Samantabhadra the bodhisattva, the eldest son among the Victor's children, the sole protector of all worlds, wishing to benefit all sentient beings, gazed upon the face of the Blessed One, caused the maṇḍalas of the earth to tremble, and spoke these words, filling all three worlds completely.

Thereupon all the great bodhisattvas, together with gods and asuras, blazing with golden rays of light, their bodies adorned with a supreme quivering radiance, rose from the great vajra-flower cushioned thrones throughout the earth, stood up from the maṇḍala, uttered the cry "Ha ha!", and spoke:

"Ah, the great dhāraṇī, inexhaustibly vast as an ocean of boundless great compassion and immeasurable qualities! Ah, the great arising of buddhas! This great dhāraṇī abides in order to fully ripen the inexhaustible realm of sentient beings, equal to the three grounds without boundary or center, abiding in the Dharma-maṇḍala without fixed abode!"

"Alas! This great dhāraṇī dispels the habitual tendencies of evil cast forth from aeons without number, drains the ocean of afflictions, and scatters the

mountains of wrong views. One who has not properly gathered the accumulation of virtue's roots across aeons without number, who has not directly beheld many hundreds of thousands of Tathāgatas, who has not accomplished awakening's purpose, who has not yet attained in full the ocean of distinctive qualities that belong to the ground of omniscience — how could any such person so much as hear this great dhāraṇī, the very essence of all Tathāgatas? To grasp it, recite it, or master it completely — what need even be said? To hear even the name of this great dhāraṇī is rare over tens of millions of aeons.

Alas! Those sentient beings in whose hands this great dhāraṇī rests have found a good finding. They live a good life. They have an excellent foundation for direct knowledge. Their roots of virtue are completely perfected. They dwell in the domain of the Tathāgatas. All qualities are perfectly complete in them. By reciting it even once, one will be freed from all sufferings of the lower realms. By reciting it twice, one will be freed from all misdeeds. By reciting it three times, one will be freed from all afflictions. And so, by mere recitation, the qualities increase progressively, and one will come to behold the Tathāgatas. If one recites it while walking, one will be freed from all suffering. If one recites it at the foot of a single standing tree, all accomplishments will be attained. If one recites it while on a journey, all sentient beings will come under one's sway. If one sits cross-legged inside a great forest and recites it seven times, one will attain great meditative concentration and will also become free from all afflictions.

If one sits cross-legged before an image of the noble Samantabhadra and offers whatever flowers and other things one has, then recites this great dhāraṇī until the body grows weary, and upon being weary lies down right there, one will behold the bodhisattva Samantabhadra in a dream. He will touch that person with his right hand, grant him perfect solace, and bestow upon him the great radiance of Dharma. He will also speak thus: 'Excellent! Excellent! O child of the Victors! You have entered the great maṇḍala of the Tathāgata. When you pass from this life, you will attain the great ground.' Then one will awaken possessed of physical ease, mental ease, great joy, clarity, and supreme delight. One will also be renowned as one of great power and great authority. The gods themselves will come to behold that person. Rising at dawn, one should read the sūtras fully gathered by the bodhisattvas. One should also arouse a mind of benefit and happiness toward all sentient beings. Thereupon all the perfections will be completely fulfilled, separation

from all misdeeds will come about, the forces of affliction will be vanquished, and the Tathāgatas themselves will sing one's praise. Gods and others will strive to guard, protect, and shelter that person. A child of the Victors who practices exactly as has been taught in this way will, without long delay, enter upon the great ground of Samantabhadra."

Thereupon Vajraketu and the other great lords of vidyā-mantras, sovereigns of the three-thousandfold world, together with Mahānetra and the other great vidyā-mantra-holders, together with Vajragarbha and the other great bodhisattvas, mahāsattvas, together with Vajrapāśa and the other great divine lords of vidyā-mantras,

together with Ratnajālinī and the other great goddesses of vidyā-mantras, together with the goddess Tārā and the other deities of the maṇḍala of the great bodhisattvas, together with Mahādhvaja, Surūpa, Atidarśanīya, and the other youths, and the young women, the male attendants and the female attendants, together with Acala and the other great leaders of the wayward, together with Śreṣṭhakāya and the other lords of rākṣasas, together with Māmakī and the other rākṣasī-women, together with the Great Lord (Śiva) and the other divine sovereigns — all of these, together with Vajrapuṣpakūṭa and all the bodhisattvas and others assembled in the great maṇḍala, rose from their seats and offered praise to the supreme noble bodhisattva, the great being Samantabhadra, by means of one hundred and eight names, in a hymn called "The Illumination of Unsurpassed Qualities."

Samantabhadra, supreme among all,
great in wealth encompassing all variety,
the supreme vajra of the great maṇḍala,
lord of all directions, bearing manifold forms —

Great Vajra, greatly joyous,
of vast splendor and immense power,
the overpowering and the wholly overpowering, supreme in glory,
all-pervading, victorious in wisdom, king among victors —

Great Vajra, supremely laughing,
accomplishing what is most difficult to accomplish,
reveling in the great music,
greatly joyous tamer of beings —

Great God, great sovereign,
the mighty Viṣṇu, lord of creatures,

delighting in what is above the earth, below the earth, and on the earth,
likewise the earth-holder and the triple-grounded —

skilled in the gradual means of discipline and generosity,
supremely knowing, master of a thousand realms,
companion of knowledge, delighting in patience,
diligence itself, supremely wealthy —

endowed with ten diligences and ten skillful means,
the eldest great son of the ten powers,
inspired by a thousand powers and strengths,
fully complete and dispeller of the ten —

great king who removes all dust,
the king whose maṇḍala is like an ocean,
fully skilled in the means of quieting the dusty particles,
knowing the rites, possessing wisdom —

wise, beautiful, of excellent fortune,
supremely lovely, giving rise to joy,
arising from the great heart-essence,
freed from afflictions, difficult to overcome —

equal to the earth, equal to the sky,
with a domain of activity like the wind,
splendor itself, matchless in splendor,
like the waters of the four oceans —

dispelling confusion and madness,
swallowing up afflictions that are hard to overcome,
the battle-ender, rejoicing in battle,
utterly crushing the faults of conflict —

whose beautiful speech resounds with the tone of the swan,
son of the great sovereign of the close and powerful sense-faculties,
surpassing the sense-faculties, equal to the Capable One (Śākyamuni),
upholding the Dharma, shown to be endowed with wealth —

greatly joyous, calming drunkenness and derangement,
drying up the mire and mud of afflictions,
dispelling the pestilence of pride in the sense-faculties,
utterly crushing the arrogance of the wrathful —

endowed with pleasant and gentle speech,
the equal and the unequal among equals,
the unequaled, thoroughly transcending all domains,
sharing the sphere of activity with all buddhas —

greatly reveling in the heart of awakening,
virtuous in teaching the gradations step by step,
auspicious with beautiful and fully perfect eyes,
bestowing the pure and noble path —

the purifier, the best of fire-offerings, the best of gifts,
the crusher who utterly crushes all obstructors,
the bestower who is the incomparable speaker,
the singular light of the vajra-world —

lord of the assembly of men and women,
the one who certainly enriches with qualities,
the one who pacifies sentient beings in saṃsāra,
steadfast, freed from all misdeeds —

the one who shines forth utterly victorious in all things,
possessing the maṇḍala of all victors,
creating the illumination of all oceans,
the one who removes all faults —

the fearsome churner of what lies beneath the earth,
likewise the one who exhausts and brings to an end,
the churner of the ocean of afflictions,
the one who exhausts all sides of affliction —

the one who radiates the hardship of blazing fire,
the one who pacifies arrogance and bellowing pride,
the Great Vajra, generator of power,
the one who utterly crushes all hostility —

the remover of misdeeds in those who have entered the far shore,
the pure one whose domain of activity is the sky.

the one who bestows purity and bestows qualities,
the one who bestows fruit and bestows all,
the one who bestows wisdom and bestows merit,
the one who bestows enjoyment and bestows victory —

the one who bestows lordship and bestows speech,
the one who bestows wealth, possessed of the accumulations, holder of the vajra,
the one who bestows form, the hero who is utterly victorious,
the one who bestows the pure and virtuous way of conduct —
the source of bliss, bearing the jewel upon the crown,
the holder of the earth, difficult to grasp,
the one who accomplishes the pleasing of the maṇḍala,
the one who descends and likewise causes descent —
equal to a precious net of jewels,
the lamp that dispels darkness, endowed with victory,
possessed of qualities, wisdom, and the Great Vehicle,
possessed of the dharmatā of supreme and great stability —
of great speech and great wisdom,
the one who excellently reveals the manner of a buddha,
possessed of the great worship of the Great Vehicle,
endowed with the unsurpassed vehicle —
the knower of the Dharma of great worship,
the supreme Dharma of the great fruit,
the Teacher who teaches and tames, the Instructor,
the peaceful one who likewise pacifies —
the good one, identical in nature with the good,
the one who dispels all-pervading darkness,
the knower of the essence of compassion and wisdom,
the one who possesses the maṇḍala of the light of compassion —
the one in whom great compassion is perfectly complete,
the one who purifies the great festival times,
the supreme weapon, clear and lofty,
the one whose domain of activity transcends great strife —
the one who protects all beings and has wide eyes,
the one possessed of the freedoms and endowments so difficult to find,
whose inward conduct is entirely wholesome,
the holy giver who bestows supreme joy —
the one who everywhere holds sway over all domains,
the one who forever possesses gentle dignity,

tamed and equal to all buddhas,
the lotus of the great maṇḍala —

the one who employs skillful means that cool like the moon,
the wise one who has abandoned arrogance and who knows the rites,
the one who abides in a single domain of activity,
the one who possesses the wisdom of the Tathāgata —

the knower of the reality of the great samaya,
the great master of widespread renown,
the holy one himself, unsurpassed,
the one who extensively propagates the waves of secret mantra —

In this way the great all-pervading lord
is exalted by the perfume of a hundred qualities.
The pure, the enlightened, the skilled, and so forth,
the king of awareness-mantras arising from the source of qualities —

the one who bears the jewel upon the crown, and so forth:
having been praised by those supreme ones,
the Blessed One, the vanquisher of the river of suffering,
spoke these words:

"Wonderful! These are the hundred great praises,
the noble one hundred and eight names.
Whoever among human beings removes their misdeeds
and praises Samantabhadra from the heart with these —
that one will attain buddhahood itself.

Whoever recites these one hundred and eight names
will be fully replete with qualities,
and will be able to speak without remainder
of the vast wisdom that accords with the manner of the Tathāgata."

Thus, decisively arising from the confidence of a hundred qualities, the son of
the supreme Sage — with the manifold qualities arising, and those beings up
to the ends of the world having expanded qualities — if one makes the great
praises, and if one praises the Victor's son each day with praise, one will
become a form possessed of the ten powers, will attain illumination, and will
become a source of pure and immaculate qualities.

The one hundred names of the noble Samantabhadra.

Translator's Notes

- The text opens with the colophon closing the preceding text on Ākāśagarbha's names, then immediately begins the new text on Samantabhadra's one hundred and eight names. These are treated as two sequential items and translated accordingly.

The Sanskrit dhāraṇī syllables are reproduced as-is from the Tibetan phonetic transcription rather than reconstructed, as is standard practice for dhāraṇī passages; minor scribal variants in the Tibetan transliteration are preserved rather than emended.

The phrase rendered "without fixed abode" for "gnas pa med pa'i" carries the Mahāyāna technical sense of the non-abiding nirvāṇa (apratīṣṭhitanirvāṇa), where the bodhisattva abides in neither saṃsāra nor a quiescent nirvāṇa — a doctrinally significant point worth noting.

- [illegible]

The verse "समन्तभद्राः सगुणैर्दत्ताः समस्तैर्देवैश्च..." is metrically dense prose-verse in the original, with significant ellipsis; the rendering follows the most doctrinally coherent reading, connecting "the son of the supreme Sage" with Samantabhadra as subject throughout.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.